amoy china.

Chs W. le Gendre.

No 19.

5 Enclosures.

a report to the Hon. Secretary of State — Visit to Formosa on behalf of the crew of the Bark Rover — What the Vice-Roy at Foochow. Foo says — Interviews with the Formosa officials — What they say — What they promise to do — What they have done so far, as reported by the English Consul in Tamsui & a Chinese Village Chief in Lamgkiau Kwan Tsai — Testimony of the only Survivor of the crew — Conclusions.

Received

No. 19.

W. Smith

Consulate of the U.S. at Amoy China May 1864.

The Honorable W. H. Seward

Secretary of State

Washington D.C.

DEPT. OF STATE
SEP 10 '67

Sir.

Referring to my dispatch No. 17, I beg to state that I arrived at Too Chow Foo on the 2nd of April last. I immediately secured an interview with His Excellency the Vice roy of the Fokkien Province, to whom I read the communication of Mr McPhail of Formosa [Enclosure No. 1 in my dispatch to your honor, No. 17], at the same time respectfully calling his attention to Articles XI & XIII of the Treaty of Tientsin [18th June 1858], and finally requesting him to order the Civil and Military Authorities of Formosa to immediately rescue, if possible, such of the Survivors of the Rover's crew that might yet remain in the hands of the Aborigines, and to inflict prompt punishment, with the utmost rigour, on the perpetrators of the murder of our citizens.

The Vice Roy of Too-chow-foo informed by me of the Rover tragedy.

His orders to the Formosa officials.

His Excellency complied at once with my request [Enclosure No. 1].

[No. 1.]

Having been detained in Tamsui, I reached Tuisuafoo, with the U.S. Steamer Ashuelot, Commander Febriger, on the 18th of April, when I wrote to the

Reaches Tai-wan-foo on the 18th of April.

the Authorities of the island [Enclosure No 2]. [No 2.]

In answer to my dispatch, the following day, I received joint Communications from the Taotai, General, and Prefect, the Highest Officials of the Island [Enclosure No 3]. [No 3.]

I secured an interview with those officers whom I visited jointly with Commander Tebrigge, on the 19th. We were received with the utmost cordiality and the greatest distinction; but the General, although promising to send a force to the seat of the tragedy, declined to avail himself of the presence of our forces to effect a landing of his troops. He remarked with reason that, having the responsibility of the operation, he should Conduct it with perfect independence of action. I observed that some of the unfortunate might then be yet in the hands of the Aborigines, and that no time should be lost in rescuing them. To which the Taotai answered that he knew from Certain and Official Source that all of the wrecked Crew of the Rover had been murdered. I remarked to the Taotai and the General that from my own experience of war operations, I should judge the landing of a force under cover of the Nebuleki guns so safe, that I would not hesitate one instant to land with the

May wish to Formula official

the Chinese troops if they were only ordered to proceed at once to the seat of the tragedy. Captain Jebriger offered them to tow the junks carrying the troops. To which the General said that his troops were not ready; asked him when they would be ready, that Captain Jebriger and myself might wait a few days. The General then very politely remarked that he would be happy to have our company at any time, but that he desired to do whatever would have to be done in this case, alone. That the Chinese forces were adequate to the task before them, and that although much obliged to Captain Jebriger and myself for our offers he would respectfully decline accepting them. We then left thanking those officers for their reception but emphatically stating that the United States would insist upon the strict observance of the Treaty.

that the U.S. will insist upon the strict observance of the Treaty.

Just before we left the Prefect wrote us that he had again called the attention of the Taotai and of the General upon the importance of immediately sending troops against the Aborigines. [illegible]

Inquisition at Tamsui.

We Taotai I visited H.B.M. Vice Consul to whom I showed a copy of his dispatch [this Copy left at Tamsui] to the Taotai of Formosa, in which he claims the "Rover" as an English vessel. He promised to rectify this error [of Linguist] at an early date by

by writing to the Captain a letter that would explain how it happened. The Vice Consul Kindly furnished me with a sketch of the bay where the "Rosei" crews were murdered, and which I immediately handed over to Capt. Febriger. The Vice Consul also told me that the Chinese Authorities of Formosa had so far failed to take any steps towards rescuing the wrecked Crew of the "Rosei" and punishing the murderers of such as are reported to have lost their lives by the hands of the Aborigines [22 of April].

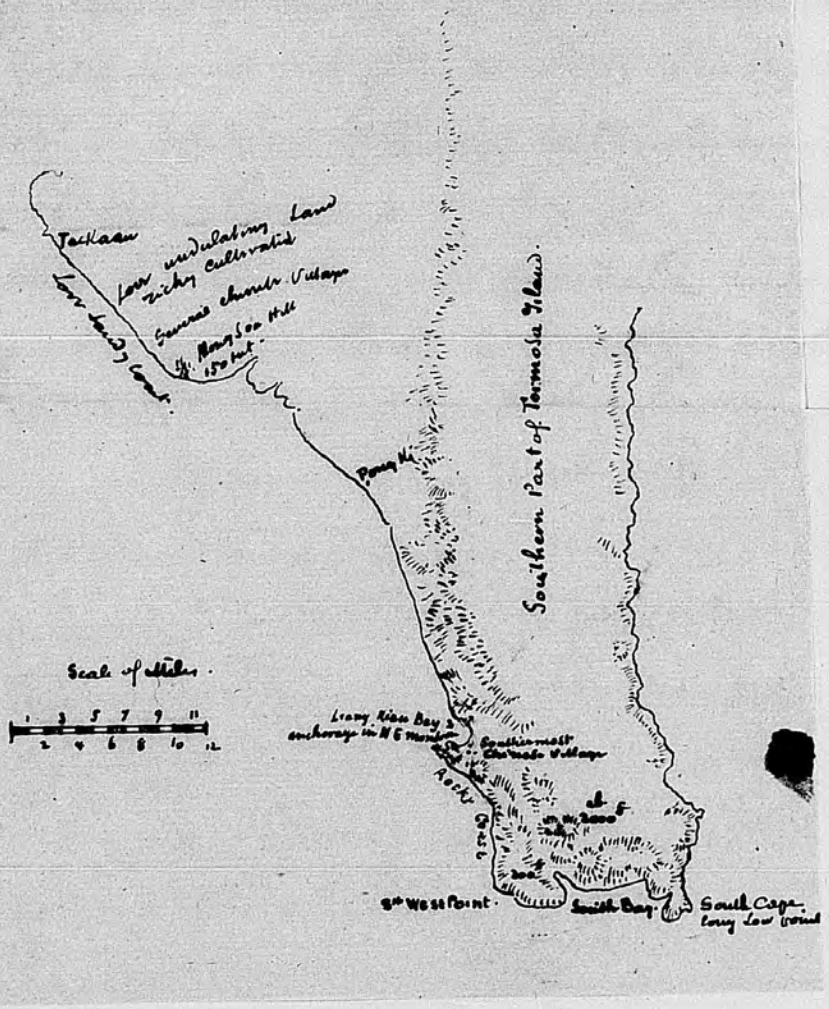
At Tang Kaiow Bay, the last Chinese village, [24 M.s] south of Takao, Captain Febriger and myself examined the Chief of the Settlement, in his own house. The Chief said that he had furnished Captain Bond of H.B.M. sloop "Cormorant", with pilots and interpreter, when he went on the 26th of March to the Scene of the occurrence. That we could have the same pilots, but not the interpreter, this interpreter had returned sometime since confirming the murder of all and every one of the crew of the brig "Rosei" by the Aborigines. He [the chief], said also that so far the Chinese Authorities had not sent forward any force against the Aborigines or anyone to enquire about the Circumstances of the murder [24 of April].

Visit to Tang Kaiow Bay

Captain Febriger concluded to here the

Pilots

Southern Part of Formosa.



Pilots offered to him and we proceeded South; we came to an anchor opposite the scene of the murder, without the least difficulty. A small junk that was at anchor was hauled in, and four of her crew were examined by Captain Tebrijs and by myself. [Enclosure No 4]. [No 4]

We made the Southernmost point of the Island.

Examination of a Junk

Evidently these men were not Siamese and belong to a class of Chinese living on the coast in various Chinese villages from Patao to the extreme South of the island, and who furnish Chal, Powder, and Guns to the Aborigines, who pay them back in wood. Yet as the Chinese Government might have hereafter claimed them to be their Spies, and them in view of future military operations connected with the wreck of the Rover, I did not judge it advisable to arrest them, but in conjunction with Captain Tebrijs, I requested them to Communicate with the Aborigines for the purpose of procuring the burial of the remains of our unfortunate Countrymen, and the purchase of such as might remain of their effects or Valuables, and for which I promised to pay a liberal price, if ever forwarded to me or handed over when I should return. They promised that they would do their best to comply with my desire but they emphatically refused to lead me to Chone when I had the strongest desire

Why we did not arrest these men.

They refused to lead us to Chone.

desire to venture on a formal conquest with one capable of acting as an interpreter. They repeatedly answered that should they make such an attempt they would be murdered by the aborigines.

The Bay at this point is navigable for any boat, but chiefly to Steamers of light draft like the "Schuylot", but very few rocks are noticeable, if we except reefs that outcrop at low water here and there near the Shore. Under cover of Guns, even a very small party of men could land at any point, and to the Eastward of the bay a force might be thrown on shore at any time and indefendently of the Ships protection, the ground there being bare and having Commanding heights near at hand, which extending all along the banks of the bay, could afford a Commanding road to the Shore, at the centre of the bay. Then the exact position of the Aborigines village being ascertained the landed force might advance without fear of any serious obstacles, towards the Settlement that would undoubtedly be the object of the expedition.

From my actual observation I am prepared to say that the shore of the bay is settled by a mixed race, a Cross breed of Aborigines and

What the Southern Bay is.

What the Settlements on the Southern Bay are.

and Chinese most of whom were Tails as the Chinese themselves do, and my impression is that the Saxon settlements which that race have made along the coast and which appears to the eye to be a few huts scattered on the flats and on the low grounds, form a mere veil to conceal the presence of the Aborigines at that point. Although this mixed race affect to be in a state of constant warfare with the aborigines, I am satisfied that they keep closely connected with them, by taking each others women for wives, by trading with them, and assisting them in their plunder and crimes, affecting afterwards as mere victims and witness to the strength and power of their would be enemies and bring it as a sort of bugbear to the Chinese or other nations that might propose to land with a view of their total extermination.

It is universally admitted that the bay at the Southern coast of the island of Formosa is a point that should be kept clear from such hordes, for it is the only point with four others situated on the Western shore extending ten miles towards the north, to Tenchew bay, that offers a sort of natural refuge on that inhospitable Coast. The Eastern coast of Formosa is extremely high and falls

The Southern Bay should be kept clear from such tribes.

falls down abruptly like a wall of rampart into the waters of the ocean and that extends to the mouth or the back bone of the island.

How many unfortunate that left Hongkong and were never heard of, being reported to have been lost at sea, were murdered on that shore? and how many more will be? until prompt and efficient measures are taken to stop the evil?

On the 24 of April we weighed our anchors, & arriving on Amoy on the 26th at 9 o'c. am. I received there a copy of the examination of Zeh Kwang, the only known survivor of the crew of the bark Rosse sent to me by the U.S. Consul at Swatow [Enclosure N° 6]. [N° 5] I had already left Amoy when Zeh Kwang arrived & there, onboard of H.B.M.s Commorant and Mr E. M. Smith the deputy Consul had neglected to examine the man.

In connection with the foregoing, I beg to offer to your Excellency the following Conclusions. 1° — That so far, in accord with Captain Tebbetts, acting under the orders of Rear Admiral Bell, I have simply urged upon the Chinese Authorities at Foo-Chow and Formosa to rescue such of the survivors of the Rosse's crew that might yet be in the hands of the aborigines according to Art.s XI & XIII of

the

Thousands of men have perished on southern coast

Examination of Zeh Kwang

Conclusions

the Treaty of Tientsin, and to do something that
could be considered by the United States as a sufficient
punishment of these wild tribes for the past and an
efficient warning for the future.

2° ——— No other efforts were made by Captain
Talcahuano and myself to secure the prompt action of
the Chinese Government in that direction, for we feared
that by interfering in the least way with the movements
of the Chinese officials, they might claim as a redeem-
ing point of their inaction, our own intervention and
as a sequence present Your Excellency from hereafter
claiming indemnities for the families of such of the
Rover's crew that might have been saved, if the
Chinese had been more prompt in allowing them
the relief they were entitled by treaty to receive
from the Formosa Authorities.

I have the honor to be

Sir

Your Obedient Servant

Chs. W. Le Gendre

U.S. Consul

at Amoy

Enclosure.

Envoy - Chiefs.

With dispatch no 19.

Dispatch written to the Press of Bermuda by order of the Vice Roy of the Floridas Province at the request of Gen.l De Lesseps U.S. Consul.

No 1.

May 10 1866.

The Taotai and Prefect of Chefoo to the Prefect of Formosa

May business you, on the 5th day of the 3rd moon [of 4th April] the NS Consul, General Le Gendre called on our Excellencies the Governor and Viceroy, stating that the Winds blew to the port of Takao, and the wild people killed more than 10 more Americans. The Consul Le Gendre takes a man of war there to manage this case, and he requests him [the Viceroy] to give orders to the Local Authorities of Formosa to assist the Consul to Conduct these negociations

The Viceroy says that on conveyance of the Consul not writing an official letter, he cannot write officially. The Viceroy orders me to write you, when the Consul goes to Formosa, you will try to investigate this case immediately. Find out all the truth to report to the Taotai, and let the Taotai order the civil and military offices to search and seize every one and report to them and to carry out the Government laws, so that we keep friendly with other nations.

If the Consul takes measures to manage these affairs himself please, insist him not to do so, for these Savages might give him more troubles.

trouble than he thinks.

I am respectfully your most obedient, humble
servant will give a safe passage over
[illegible]
[illegible]

[illegible]

A true copy of the original dispatch sent
[illegible]
[illegible]

Enclosure.

Amount - Lisbon.

Cash disbursed as per	
Disbursements to the Purser of Frigate by order of the Minister Plenipotentiary at the Court of Spain	
Amount	1 [illegible]

Enclosure No 1.
With Despatch No 18.

肅巖仁兄大人閣下小晤啟者本初五日合衆國駐廈領事李謂見
督撫憲面稟有該國船遭風飄至打狗港口地方被生番將該
國人殺斃十四名該領事李即帶兵船駛往拿辦請飭台
灣地方協同辦理
督撫憲以無申陳到院憑空難以行札諭弟等亟仰
台端一俟該領事到地迅速查明事果實確回明
道憲嚴飭文武地方官盡數搜拿一向詳覆察辦以正
國法而柔遠人倘領事旬行帶兵查拿務要力阻斷不可台
人強悍謹防節外生枝耳肅此奉佈順請
升安餘祈
心照鵠候

Consulate of the United States of America
on board the H.B.M. Schooner
13th of the 2nd year April 14th 1864
His Honor The Governor, Prefect, and The Justices
of Tuticorin Island of Ceylon
Sir

I have been informed that the American
Bark Rover on the 7th March 1864 [7th inst
yesterday] was upon a rock upon the Southern
Coast of Ceylon and was so much injured
that Captain Thomas the Commander obliged
to take to the boats

The Master his wife the 2nd Mate and
three Sailors escaped in the first boat and
landed on the South west point of the island
about fifty miles East of Jaffna, where they
are reported to have all been murdered with
the exception of one Chinese Sailor who escaped

The second boat with the Mate and Seven
Sailors is supposed to have landed in the same
locality and to have met with the same fate

The Chinese who escaped from the
first boat came to Aripo at the Consulate and
gave intelligence of the tragedy. I have sent
him to his home Penang at the expense of
the

B

the United States. I now come to request that immediate investigation be made of this case and if any of the Crew of the Bark Rescue are in the hands of the natives that they be immediately rescued and delivered over into my hands that I shall persue implicated in this outrage be tryed and punished in accordance with the 6th Article of the Treaty Concluded between the United States and the Empire of China Captain Zebrig Commander of the U.S. Steamer Mohaclot informs me that in case you require any assistance he will be glad to join you in the efforts you make towards this end & shall be very glad to know that you have accepted his offer.

Respectfully &c

Signed Chas W Lay

Consul of the U.S. of America

His Excellency the Viceroy and Governor of the Formosan Provinces

Requested to be handed over to me a letter from the High Authorities of Tamsui relating to this affair & shall be happy to deliver it when I have the honor of meeting you.

Enclosure No 2.
With Dispatch No 18.

總辦通商局務署福州府正堂尹
提調通商局務陞用道延平府正堂李

臺灣府正堂葉

公文遞至

當堂開折

Enclosure No 2
With Dispatch No 15.

為

大合衆國欽命前陸路提督駐廈正領事府李

照會事照得本合衆國二枝半桅商船名羅妹於外國本年三月十二日即中國二月初七日該船在臺灣南洋面擱礁受傷打破時為逃命計船主并其妻及第二夥長水手三名下小杉板即登該處山岸約離打狗口一百五十里之遥經報被該處之人戕害當時只有華水手一名逃脫又第二歸小船一隻內係大夥長並水手七人登岸料亦被害至該商同時有華水手逃回廈門稟報此案經由本署給盤費付該水手返回汕頭家鄉至本領事查得此案為此迅速照請嚴查究辦如該商船羅妹尚有人等未盡被害祈即查明送交本領事如果已被害務祈認真移營盡力搜捕所有同謀隱害該難商一切人犯極效盡法以期遵照

大合衆國當日與

貴國欽定和約第十一款及第十三款認真嚴辦以正國法現准

大合衆國欽命督理亞士休落鐵兵船總兵官費米雅知照設如

貴鎮道府劉捕此案 費總兵願以極力相幫本領事十分欣慰

貴撫憲函開通商局文函知會貴處請為嚴辦此案俟本領事面會
貴總兵時面交此件為此理合照會請煩查照施行須至照會者

右　照　會

提督銜福建臺澎水陸地方掛印總兵官　淩　阿　已　圖魯劉

大清欽加三品頂戴按察使司銜福建分巡臺澎等處兵備道兼提督學政署福建臺灣府正堂加十級紀錄十次葉

同治六年三月十三日照會

With dispatch no 49.

Answer of the Tavlay —
Prefet - General of Tarnopol
to my dispatch of the 17
of April 1867.

No 3.

May 20 - 1867.

The General Liu, Taotai Hsu and the Prefect of Tsingtao to General Le Gendre U.S. Consul

Tsingtao April 19th 1867

Sir.

We received your letter of the 18th April stating [here follows copy of Consul's letter of 17th April Enclosure No 2]

The Taotai states that on the 13th instant he received a dispatch from H.B.M. Consul M'Connell stating that a British vessel on her way to Kau Chiu had struck on a rock near "Red Head" Island and that 14 men were alleged to take about to Loong Chiu Bay called by the natives Tsu Wah Lan Peh Sua that on landing 13 men were killed and one escaped that the latter on reaching Miao a Kau was assisted by a native official with a canoe to proceed to Tahao where he visited the British Consulate.

The Taotai states that on receiving this dispatch he immediately requested Colonel Liu and the district Magistrate to accompany Colonel to the spot indicated and enquire into the matter, ordering that none of the people be allowed to visit the natives (aborigines) and

and cause trouble. On the 3rd instant these two officers report that they went to Kot Bia to examine and take action in the case and also to see the British Consul Carroll and the Commissioner of Customs White, who afraid on stating that the Aborigines resemble wild beasts and cannot comprehend the usages of civilized nations society further that the Savages conceal themselves in the forest and constantly open fire upon those who approach them making it exceedingly difficult to employ troops &c &c. Again Mr. Carroll wrote a letter of thanks a copy of which we now send for your information.

On receipt of information relative to the massacre of the Master and crew of the Rover by the Savages prior to your arrival we issued directions to the civil and Military Authorities to adopt measures for the management of the affair. But the Savages live in a wild state in the hills and it is difficult to employ Soldiers against them as the British Consul and all others well know, and as they are like apes and their Country is unexplored they are not subject to the Chinese Government hence the Chinese Government has from early times forbidden

Commenced

Commercial intercourse with them or to enter their country, and on the borders at the passes are placed guards to prevent these fierce Savages from passing to and fro, now in the case of this disease which unexpectedly entered the place and whose creed suffered from ignorance, if any evil show of Zeal can do it no endeavour will be spared to bring the offenders to immediate and condign punishment, in order that terms of good fellowship and harmony may exist between China and the foreign Power We cannot dare to trouble you for the military [or naval] assistance in the matter since in the event of any accident we should feel more than ever grieved.

We have again directed the civil and military authorities to dispatch troops and constabulary to carry on operations. We would not request the presence of your men of war to assist us in these operations

We have &c.

Enclosure no 3.
With Dispatch No 18-

欽加二品頂戴按察使司銜福建分巡臺澎等處地方兵備道兼提督學政吳
欽加提督銜福建臺澎水陸等處地方掛印總鎮巡洋凌 阿已圖會劉

署福建臺灣府正堂加十級紀錄十次葉

照覆事本年三月十四日准

貴領事照會照得合衆國二枝半桅商船名羅妹于外國本年三月十二日即中國二月初七日該船在臺灣南洋港面擱礁受傷打破時為逃命計船主並其妻及第二夥長水手三名下小杉板即登該處山岸約離打狗口一百五十里之遙經報被該處之人戕害當時只有華水手一名逃脫又第二號小船一隻內係大夥長並水手七人登岸料亦被害至該商同時有華水手逃回厦門稟報此案經由本署給盤費付該水手返回汕頭家鄉至本領事查准此案為此迅速照請嚴查究辦如該商船羅妹尚有人等未盡被害祈即查明送交本領事如果被害務祈認真移營盡力搜捕所有同謀陷害該難商一切人犯拯致盡法以期遵照

大合衆國當日與

貴國欽定和約第十一款并及十三款認真嚴辦以正國法現准

大合衆國欽命督理亞士係落總兵官貴本日知照到

貴道鎮府劉補此案 貴總兵願以拯力拥帶本領事

貴處業經所請日前本領事船自香港回奉
貴督撫憲面飭通商局文函知會貴處請為嚴辦此案俟本領事面會
貴道與時面交此件為此理合照會請煩查照須至照會者等因准此查此案於本年二月十八日本司道先准
貴領事府函開本月初八日有敝國帆放船一號駛至琅璚洋次紅頭嶼沖礁擊碎船中夥計共十四名駕小杉
板逃生至琅璚尾龜仔角臭山登岸被該處生番捉殺十三人僅存一人走至猫仔坑庄車城街衆
貴轅琅璚匠首人等將船夥一名發配貨船來旗交敝署收領等因當經本司道撿行鳳山縣赶日會營設法查
辦具覆一面禁止中外人等嗣後不得輕入番境致生事端隨接鳳山縣吳令稟稱遵於二十九日會
南路營凌叅將馳往旂后查辦並接見
領事府
貴均云生番行同獸類不可理喻且該處叢林叢雜生番匿跡放鎗特其長技難以用兵云云又經
稅務司惠
貴領事致函申謝抄錄呈
電自悉一切是
貴國羅妹商船主夥在生番地界攔礁被戕本司道等於
貴領事未到之先早經撿行營縣設法查辦而其行同獸類匿居內山難以用兵又為

- Enclosure No. 3 -
With Dispatch No 118 -

大英國領事各官所共知茲准前因查臺地生番穴處猱居不隸版圖為 王化所不及是以我國早有土牛之禁士庶商民不准擅入又於各番隘口多設隘丁重重防護所以避克悍而嚴出入也今該船陡被風灾誤陷絕地誠為思慮防範所不及若苟可盡力搜捕緝獲懲治斷無不飛速撿行以副我朝中外和好至意更無煩

貴國兵力相帮辦理設或損戚失事愈抱不安除再飭鳳山營縣派撥兵役設法查辦外所有貴國兵船會辦此案之處請不必行為此照覆請煩

貴領事查照須至照會者

計粘抄 貴領事來函一紙

右 照 會

大合衆國欽命前陸路提督駐廈正領事爾等

Amoy - China.

With dispatch no 15

Statement of four Chinamen trading with aborigenes at South Bay. Formosa.

No 4.

May 10 - 1867.

Statement of four chinamen examined by Capt. Fabricius & Wolff's Consul of Amoy.

Kwaro from neer ne the junk, the junk is from Tamsui fou, left Tamsui-fou 10 days ago - anchored below - Takao, place named Pang Loan, is a Chinese village, was there 8 days ago. When he left Tamsui sold cotton goods, which they disposed of at Lim Kim to Chiund, [who] gave them a letter to bring word. The letter was addressed to the mohsan to of the Indians named Möüe, he is a Canton man, lives a mile away. The boat belongs to Mouqo of Kachiring in Tamsui-foo. The junk can go into the jetty. The order of Chiund or Mouqo paid for the wood. They are now waiting here for the wind to come, they have two guns. The half breed brought the word to the [張千總 the name of the Captain] Camp Vah Lasap, talks Amoy [the Chinese of his name]

First man.

Second man.

Mauqh Jee belongs to the Pedadores, is from Tamsui, has been to Pang Loan anchored at Yeau Kiau harbour, a few pieces of goods on his ship. Sold the goods to Chiund. he [Chiund] told him to get the wood through Möüe, Möüe brought the wood to the boats

does does

does not know if all the men were murderers or not, Tang Tung is the Captain of the boat, has been near Amoy and also to Taiwanfoo. There are Chinese living here, cannot correspond with them, they are going to buy their boat to Taiwanfoo, they hire the boat from Ng Kantiw — The Captain pays them $3.00 for Pilots and $2.50 per month for mariners

3d man

Lee Tung, is from Taiwanfoo he got some money to buy some wood, had no cargo, Chuah gave him the money, Chuah lives in Taiwanfoo [the owner of the boat] Ng Kan Tiw, Moöe Sold the wood to him for 18,000 cash, he saw more on the land, does not know if Moöe is a Chinaman or not, he looks like a Canton man. He [Lee Tung] took the wood on shore partially and partly brought to him on bamboo Sampans, did not know any thing about Moöe, saw him on shore, and offered him the wood for sale, he bought the wood, yesterday, had no Cotton goods shipped at Tang Loon to get water and rice, it is custom any to get wood here —

4th Man.

Koo Tong - belongs to the boat, gets $2 per month as wages, is from Tsiaufoo, has nothing on board no goods, stopped at Kong Kong below Tung Low arrived here 8 days ago bought wood from Kau Soo Moo a Canton man Moo will sell wood at 5 Cash one Bundle, that is the price, three bundles weigh about 1 pounds.

4th Mate

Amoy May 10 1867

a true copy

Wm W LeQuesne

U S Co

man went and came back, the next afternoon, with word that five of [redacted] captain's boat were murdered the afternoon of the attack. He also brought word that the other boat had arrived in the night, and the next morning. Two of them were killed. After three days I came to Tauloa. I went to the English consul. He sent a man to make enquiries about the other six men. The man came back with a report that two more men had been killed. The English consul sent a Steamer and I went along with it. The boat was still there, but all destroyed. The bottom was

Admiralty and War Office
Confidential
5.8.67.

Statement of the Chinaman Teh-Kwang, belonging to Mr. O— in the Kiukiang District, taken by the U.S. Consul at Swatow, with the assistance of Rev. Wm Ashmore, as Interpreter.

I shipped at the U.S. Consulate, Feb. 28, 1867, on the boat "Rover". Sailed from the Port Saturday morning, March 9th. Had stiff winds and were under close reefed top sails. At about 11 o'c. on the night of Tuesday, March 12, we struck a rock on the bar-shoal Side. Had seen Formosa the evening before, and were keeping off. When we struck, we at once lowered the sails, after which she slid off the rock, went a little distance and then struck on the other side. The Captain shifted the helm and then she began to move. The captain then set the men to the Pumps, but no water came; they would not draw. I think the Pumps were injured by the blow; they were in good order before. The Captain sent the 1st mate down, with a light into the hold. He found that the water was already over the ballast. The Captain ordered the Boats. We all got into two boats. The Captain had six in it, himself, his wife, the 2d mate, myself, another Sailor and the

Cook. There was taken in the boat, a bed quilt and some clothing, some water, a little food, a Small quantity of Spirit, a compass and Sextant, Mrs. Hunt took a Small box. The Second boat had in it, the 1st Mate, the Cabin boy, five Sailors & the Sailors cook. We pushed off about one o'clock. We kept in company rowing until day light. We Stayed on board as long as we could; the water was getting so high that we were afraid to Stay any longer. At day light we saw Formosa. We rowed in until about 4 o'c P.M., the tide also setting us in; when we landed, we saw no one. The Capt. told us that he thought we need not fear, but we must get ashore to Save our lives. About 10 o'c. we lost Sight of the Second boat. We pulled the boat up to the Shore. We took on Shore all there was in the boat. Our clothes were wet; we took them off, wrung out the water and laid them out to dry. The Captain Sent me to find Some fresh water; I found it and brought Some back - a bucket full. The place where we landed was a Sand beach at the foot of a mountain, very densely wooded. While we were drying our clothes, the Savages came out of the jungle, to the number of 15 or 16; there were one

or two women among them with long dresses and ear rings, the men had no clothing but the breech cloth. When they came out of the bushes, they were armed, some had guns, some knives, some had bows and arrows. The Captain called out to talk to the bush. At once some of the natives ran to where our things were, then pursued us into the bushes. I hid myself into the bushes. I heard them pursuing. The Savages made a great noise & calling out. I heard several guns fired. I do not know certainly whether they got any one or not. After a while I saw them come back and divide the plunder. Then they went back the way they came. After all was still, I came out. I called several times the names of the Captain and others. No answer came. Then I found some biscuit which the Savages had rejected, which I took. When night came on I started off, making my way Westward. I had a moon until 10 O.C. The next morning at daylight, I went to where some Chinese were. The Chinese Settlement was not more than nine or twelve miles (English) away. I got to this Chinese Settlement, and told what had happened, and got a man to go and buy the Savages not to kill them but let them be ransomed. I had no money to hire

this man, but the Kind people contributed about three Dollars to hire him. The man was a Chinaman, the only one who ventures among them. This man is a Chinaman's Son by one of their women. The man went and came back, the next afternoon, with word that five of the Captain's boat were murdered the afternoon of the attack. He also brought word that the other boat had arrived in the night, and the next morning. Two of them were killed. After three days I came to Taulan. I went to the English Consul. He sent a man to make enquiries about the other six men. The man came back with a report that two more men had been killed. The English Consul sent a Steamer and I went along with it. The boat was still there, but all destroyed; the bottom was Knocked out. Three boats went ashore from the Steamer, with 30 or 40 men. While they were making or landing for the officers, I having gone ashore first, was fired upon. There were 30 or 40 Shots fired all in quick Succession. The Captain ordered the men back. One man was Highly wounded in his Stomach. There were no arms in the Rovers Boats. The man of war brought me to Amoy. I arrived in Amoy the 31st day of March.

Swatow April 9th 1867.

a true Copy.
(Signed) J. C. de Venegata
U.S. Consul

Amoy May 11. 1867.
a true Copy
Chas W. Lafendre
U.S. Consul

Amoy No. 5. 1867.